PROMPT PACK / BUILD WITH AI

AI prompts for a better first build

Replace every bracketed input. Give the assistant concrete context and verify its work yourself.

1 / Scope the project

```
Act as a pragmatic product engineer. My user is [person] and their recurring problem is [problem]. I have [hours] over two weekends and know [stack]. Ask up to three essential questions, then suggest one smallest useful workflow, acceptance criteria, and a list of features to defer.
```

2 / Turn the workflow into tasks

```
Here is the agreed workflow: [workflow]. Break it into small implementation tasks in dependency order. For each task give inputs, outputs, a completion check, and likely failure cases. Prefer my existing stack [stack]. Explain any new dependency before introducing it.
```

3 / Build one feature

```
Implement only [bounded task] in this repository. First inspect the relevant files and explain the existing conventions. Acceptance criteria: [criteria]. Handle [failure cases]. Keep secrets out of source. Make the smallest coherent change, then show what changed and how to verify it.
```

Use redacted logs and synthetic examples. Never paste production credentials, private customer data, or secrets into prompts.

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Review. Test. Then ship.

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4 / Debug with evidence

```
Expected behaviour: [expected]. Actual behaviour: [actual]. Reproduction steps: [steps]. Redacted logs and relevant code: [evidence]. Rank likely causes. Identify the smallest observation that would confirm each cause. Do not change unrelated code. Propose a fix only after connecting it to the evidence.
```

5 / Review before sharing

```
Review [change] as a careful maintainer. Check correctness, input validation, permission checks, sensitive data handling, error behaviour, and dependency assumptions. Rank findings by impact, reference the relevant code, and explain a concrete failure scenario. Distinguish confirmed defects from questions.
```

6 / Prepare the first user test

```
My app helps [user] do [task]. Draft a 15-minute usability session: a neutral task, five non-leading questions, what to observe, and a simple record sheet. Include a test of the empty state and one failure. Avoid selling the app during the interview.
```

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